BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE OVERVIEW REPORT - SUPERSTORE SALES

1. What is Business Intelligence (BI)?

Business Intelligence is the use of tools and techniques to turn raw data into useful information. Instead of looking at thousands of Excel rows, BI tools like Power BI clean the data, create charts, and show patterns. It helps companies understand what happened, why it happened, and what might happen next.

2. Why do organisations use dashboards?

Organisations use dashboards because they give a quick, visual summary of the business in one place. Instead of reading long reports, a manager can open a dashboard and immediately see total sales, profit, best region, and worst product. Dashboards save time, reduce errors, and allow everyone to see the same information. For example, Superstore has over 9,000 orders — a dashboard makes it easy to understand without reading all 9,000 lines.

3. How do dashboards improve decision-making?

Dashboards improve decision-making in three ways:

- Faster decisions: Visuals like bar charts and line graphs show problems quickly. If profit drops in the East region, you see it immediately.

- Better filtering (Interactivity): With slicers for Region, Category and Year, a manager can ask "what if" questions. For example, "Show me only Furniture sales in West for 2017" and get an answer in 2 seconds.

- Data-driven, not guesswork: Decisions are based on real sales and profit numbers, not feelings. This leads to better stock, better marketing, and higher profit.

4. Business Objective of the Superstore Sales Dataset

The main business objective of the Superstore dataset is to analyse sales and profit performance to improve profitability and operational efficiency.

The dataset contains Customer, Region, Category, Sub-Category, Sales, Profit, and Order Date from 2014-2017. The business wants to answer:

- Which regions and categories are most profitable?

- Which products or customers are causing losses?

- How have sales trended over time (2014 to 2017)?

- Where should the business focus marketing and inventory?

For example, by analysing the data, the company can stop selling low-profit items in certain regions, focus on high-profit Technology products in the West, and plan stock for peak years.

Conclusion: In summary, BI and dashboards help Superstore move from just recording sales to actually understanding and improving sales. The dashboard created in this assignment turns raw Superstore data into clear actions for management.